

Greece

A few practical notes for your week across Athens and the Cyclades — currency, ferries, tipping, and the rest of the small things that make travel feel easy.

PASSPORT & ENTRY

Valid passport required

Greece is a Schengen Area country. US citizens do not need a visa for stays under 90 days, and the new ETIAS authorization launches in 2026 — apply online before you fly. Make sure your passport is valid for at least three months beyond your return date.

TIPPING

Modest, appreciated, never expected

Service is typically included on the bill. An extra 5–10% in cash for excellent service is gracious. €1–2 per drink at bars; €5–10 for porters and drivers; €10+ for outstanding concierge help.

TIME & WEATHER

EEST · warm, dry, breezy in mid-May

Eastern European Summer Time (UTC+3) — seven hours ahead of US Eastern. Mid-May runs 68–78°F with sunshine and the Aegean's signature meltemi breeze on the islands. Pack layers for evenings and cooler ferry decks.

CONNECTIVITY

Strong coverage on every island

T-Mobile, AT&T, and Verizon all offer competitive international plans for Greece. Wi-Fi is standard at every hotel and most cafés. Download offline Google Maps before you leave — it's faster than relying on signal in the village alleys.

CURRENCY & PAYMENTS

Euro is official

Major credit cards are accepted at hotels and most restaurants. Smaller tavernas and island shops often prefer cash. ATMs are easy to find in Athens and on every island. A small euro float is useful for taxis and tips.

LANGUAGE

Greek, with English everywhere in tourism

Greek is the official language; English is universal at hotels, restaurants, and the islands' tourist core. A kalimera (good morning) and efcharistó (thank you) are warmly received.

POWER & PLUGS

230V · European Type C / F

Two-prong European outlets, same as Continental Europe. Most modern phone and laptop chargers handle 230V automatically. Bring one or two adapters for hair tools and anything single-voltage.

FERRIES & INTER-ISLAND TRAVEL

Show up 45 minutes early

Your ferries between Mykonos, Paros, and Santorini are pre-booked on Seajets — fast, comfortable catamarans that handle the route in under an hour. Ports are small and unfussy; arrive 45 minutes ahead, your driver will help with luggage. Crossings can be choppy in heavy meltemi weeks; bring a Bonine if you're sensitive.